

MOVE, PLAY & BELONG

Family-Friendly Inclusive Sport in Partner Countries

D2.3 Needs Assesment Report

Move, Play & Belong:
Inclusive Family Sports

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Executive Summary

The Move, Play & Belong Needs Assessment identifies what socially at-risk families need to access, participate in and continue family sport in inclusive, practical and sustainable ways. It synthesises evidence from the D2.1 Survey Results Report, the Best Practice Analysis and the EU-level policy context used within WP2. The evidence comprises 208 survey responses, 180 substantive open-text responses and 25 interviews across Estonia, Italy, Latvia, Greece and Spain, alongside 18 explicitly family-focused initiatives from nine European countries.

The central finding is that participation depends on the complete family journey rather than access to an activity alone. Families must be able to find and understand an opportunity, assess its affordability and suitability, organise attendance, reach and use the venue, participate with appropriate support and identify a realistic next step. Eight needs emerge: affordable participation; clear information and supported navigation; usable local venues and manageable journeys; predictable provision with workable scheduling; physical, sensory and communication accessibility; respectful treatment, safety and belonging; meaningful whole-family participation; and a supported route into continued activity. Their relative importance varies between country samples: cost is particularly prominent in Estonia, family-oriented opportunities in Italy, timing in Latvia, and information in Greece and Spain. These differences support common inclusion principles combined with local adaptation.

The Needs Assessment recommends involving families in programme design; assessing total household costs; combining clear information with personal guidance; integrating accessibility, safeguarding and staff preparation; providing flexible but predictable family participation formats; connecting introductory activities to realistic continuation opportunities; securing usable venues and manageable journeys; and using proportionate monitoring and family feedback. Mapped practices illustrate possible mechanisms including recurring municipal provision, community partnerships, adapted family support, club pathways, family events and peer support. These should be treated as transferable design options rather than independently proven interventions.

D2.3 informs the subsequent Move, Play & Belong Framework, Active Futures Guidebook and Family Move & Play Toolkit. The Framework will be tested through the BeActive Family Beach Games in Latvia and refined using participant and stakeholder evidence. At policy level, the Needs Assessment uses a common EU-level context, with the European Union Work Plan for Sport 2024–2027 providing a relevant reference on participation, accessibility for vulnerable groups, grassroots sport and evidence-informed policy. Longer-term implementation is expected to sit with municipalities, sports organisations, clubs, NGOs and other local organisations adopting the Framework. The Needs Assessment has undergone final consortium review as the agreed expert and stakeholder validation process, with resulting feedback incorporated into this final version.

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1. Purpose of D2.3

D2.3 translates the evidence generated through Work Package 2 into a structured assessment of what socially at-risk families need to access, participate in and continue inclusive family sport. It synthesises the D2.1 family survey and interview findings, the Best Practice Analysis and the EU-level policy context used in this Needs Assessment to identify priority needs, enabling conditions and practical recommendations for the subsequent Move, Play & Belong Framework, Guidebook, Toolkit and pilot. ICSSPE leads D2.3, with contributions from the consortium partners. Section 10 documents the completed final consortium review and validation of the Needs Assessment.

The source reports define socially at-risk families as households facing social, economic, health-related or environmental disadvantages that restrict regular access to physical activity and sport. Risk can arise from low income, disability or additional support needs, migration and language barriers, rural isolation, restricted mobility, caring responsibilities or limited access to services. These circumstances can overlap, and they should not be treated as fixed attributes that determine a family's interests or abilities. For framework development, family should include parents and carers, guardians, children, siblings, grandparents and other relatives or household support figures. Interview accounts also identify single-parent, foster, separated, same-sex and multigenerational families. Participation arrangements should recognise this variety without requiring a particular household composition or the attendance of every member. Family sport includes shared activity, suitable activities undertaken in parallel, and supported roles that allow people of different ages and abilities to take part meaningfully. Attendance by one child, with adults restricted to payment, transport or observation, is insufficient evidence of whole-family inclusion. Likewise, participation in one event is distinct from a sustained and manageable activity routine. Project-stage and future implementation responsibilities are distinguished in Section 8.3. In summary, the consortium develops, tests, evaluates and disseminates the Framework in accordance with the approved work plan, while organisations that subsequently adopt it are responsible for adapting and delivering it within their own local contexts.

1.2. Scope of the recommendations

Recommendations concern access, delivery, organisational support and progression. They respond to the needs described by participating families and the design features documented in the practice mapping. They do not estimate national unmet demand, prescribe one sport for all families or establish a universal affordable fee. Decisions about frequency, charges, transport support and specialist provision should be made through local consultation and a realistic resource assessment. The Framework should combine a common minimum standard with additional support proportionate to barriers. Clear information and respectful treatment should be routine. Interpretation, transport assistance, equipment lending or sensory adaptations should then respond to the particular circumstances of a household. This approach avoids relying on demographic categories as substitutes for asking families what would make participation possible.

During the funded MPB project, the consortium is responsible for developing, validating, piloting, evaluating and disseminating the Framework in accordance with the approved work plan. Following transfer and adoption, operational responsibility for local implementation is expected to sit with the municipalities, sports organisations, clubs, NGOs and community organisations that choose or commit to applying the Framework. These organisations should use the Framework, Guidebook and Toolkit to adapt the recommended principles to their own local circumstances, resources, target groups and delivery environments.

2. Evidence Base and Synthesis Method

2.1. Evidence strands:

The evidence base for D2.3 combines the principal WP2 evidence sources available for this assessment: family surveys and interviews, desk-based research and best-practice analysis, and an EU-level policy context addressing the policy dimension of the project. Together, these sources provide complementary evidence on family experience, existing delivery models and the broader institutional and policy conditions relevant to inclusive family sport.

WP2 Strand	Evidence Consolidated	Contribution to D2.3
WP2.1 surveys and interviews	208 surveys, including 180 substantive Q15 responses, and 25 semi-structured family interviews in five countries	Reported barriers, preferences, mechanisms of exclusion and conditions supporting participation
WP2.2 desk-based research	Screening of 247 records to 99 relevant records, 40 after further screening and 18 explicitly family-focused offers in nine countries	Delivery options, transferable features, practical constraints and weaknesses in public reporting
WP2.3 policy analysis	EU-level sport-policy context, including the European Union Work Plan for Sport 2024–2027, considered alongside institutional and implementation issues identified through the family and best-practice evidence.	Provides a common European policy context for participation, accessibility, health-enhancing physical activity, grassroots sport and inclusion. The report does not undertake or claim a comparative country-by-country policy-gap analysis.

Table 1. WP2 evidence strands

The policy strand of this Needs Assessment is addressed at European Union level rather than through a comparative country-by-country policy analysis. The report therefore does not seek to determine whether individual partner countries possess or lack particular family-sport policies, funding mechanisms or statutory provisions. Instead, EU-level policy is used to provide a common strategic context against which the participation barriers, organisational needs and recommendations identified through WP2 can be considered.

A particularly relevant reference is the European Union Work Plan for Sport 2024–2027. Its priority areas include participation in sport and health-enhancing physical activity, and its guiding objectives include increasing participation at all ages and improving accessibility for vulnerable groups. The Work Plan also emphasises evidence-informed sport policy, grassroots sport and the wider contribution of sport to social cohesion, active citizenship and health. These

priorities align closely with the Move, Play & Belong focus on reducing barriers to family participation and developing accessible, inclusive and adaptable community-sport approaches.

Table 2. Survey and qualitative evidence by country

Country	Survey Responses	Substantive Q15 Responses	Interviews
Estonia	43	43	5
Italy	43	30	5
Latvia	41	41	5
Greece	41	33	5
Spain	40	33	5
Total	208	180	25

The retained practices cover Germany (five), Finland (four), Cyprus and Ireland (two each), and Bulgaria, Italy, Poland, Portugal and Sweden (one each). Germany and Italy are the only consortium countries represented in the final practice sample. The absence of retained offers from Latvia, Estonia, Greece or Spain reflects the mapping and its screening criteria; it is not evidence that relevant provision is absent in those countries.

The practice review retained EU initiatives within the mapping's ten-year period where descriptions explicitly identified participation by families or children with parents, guardians, siblings or other family members. It excluded primarily policy or guidance records, general inclusion offers, children-only provision and activities with only indirect family relevance. This screening improves the relevance of the retained examples to family sport, but means the final practice sample cannot be treated as an inventory of policy measures or all forms of inclusive activity.

2.2. How findings become needs and recommendations:

The synthesis follows five steps. First, findings are identified within each report and retained with their source and denominator. Second, related findings are grouped around stages of participation and the individual, household, organisational, community and policy levels. Third, the analysis distinguishes the barrier itself from the condition a family needs and from the organisational response that could provide it. Fourth, relevant practices are considered as possible delivery mechanisms. Finally, recommendations are prioritised by evidence convergence, consequences for exclusion, relevance to the whole family and implementation dependencies. For example, transport and distance are reported barriers; the corresponding need is an achievable journey; and possible responses include neighbourhood provision, coordinated transport or an accessible venue served by suitable public transport. These responses are alternatives to assess locally. A preference for nearby activities alone does not show which transport measure will work best. Convergence between the survey, Q15, interviews and practice descriptions increases confidence that a need deserves attention. It does not turn a small sample into a representative one or prove that a recommended response will

produce an effect. Needs reported by fewer families can still require immediate action where they determine access or safety. Priority is therefore an analytical judgement, not a score calculated from incomparable percentages.

2.3. Interpretation and evidence limitations:

Primary family survey and interview evidence is available for Estonia, Italy, Latvia, Greece and Spain. Germany is not represented in the D2.1 family dataset, which remains a limitation of the evidence base. The absence of direct German family evidence should therefore be taken into account when interpreting country-specific findings and during any subsequent localisation or implementation of the Framework; it should not be interpreted as evidence that relevant needs are absent. With 40 to 43 responses per country, a single response changes a country percentage by approximately 2.3 to 2.5 percentage points. Multi-select questions record the share selecting an option, usually among up to three choices; percentages do not sum to 100%. An option not selected is not necessarily irrelevant. Q15 and interview themes are also non-exclusive. Interview counts show the number of interviews containing a theme at least once. They indicate qualitative salience within the sample, rather than population prevalence or the number of repeated statements. The interview guide asked about barriers and continuity, so these counts reflect topics discussed in prompted conversations rather than an unprompted ranking of priorities.

Interview material varies between near-verbatim dialogue, translations and summaries. Its principal value is explaining how barriers operate and identifying experiences hidden by averages. The assessment does not infer causal relationships between a reported barrier and participation, or claim that participation has already improved health, family cohesion or social inclusion. The practice mapping is a curated sample, with uneven country coverage and substantial missing information on costs and participants. It contains no consistent outcome, satisfaction, retention or demographic data with which to independently establish effectiveness. General organisation-level reach figures must not be treated as the reach of a specific family activity. In particular, the Portugal entry's 3,708 registered athletes and unified partners refer to a 2019 census, not a measured number of families reached by the family-support programme.

3. Participation Patterns and the Needs Identified

3.1. Participation:

The recent-participation result, 116 of 208 respondents (55.8%), shows that many consulted families already engage with relevant activity. It does not show that participation is frequent, affordable or sustainable. The interviews describe families maintaining a child's involvement through considerable financial and organisational effort, joining an event without a next step, or attending provision that leaves carers and siblings outside the activity. The framework should therefore address the experience and sustainability of participation alongside first access.

The leading reported barrier differs by sample: cost in Estonia (33 of 43; 76.7%); lack of family opportunities in Italy (16 of 43; 37.2%); unsuitable times in Latvia (23 of 41; 56.1%); and lack of information in Greece (21 of 41; 51.2%) and Spain (18 of 40; 45.0%). These results identify different points at which the participation journey becomes difficult. They support local prioritisation, with the wider set of needs retained in every setting.

3.2. Cross-source convergence:

Several findings recur sufficiently to shape the shared framework. Table 3 brings together selected quantitative and qualitative findings, retaining their different units of analysis.

Table 3. Selected findings informing shared needs

Finding	Reported Evidence	Meaning for the Assessment
Low-cost access and perceived value	78 of 208 (37.5%) chose free activity or EUR 1 to 5 per family member; 81 (38.9%) said affordability depended on what was included	Consider total household cost and explain the content of the offer; no universal price threshold is established
Local provision	134 of 208 (64.4%) selected activities closer to home	Evaluate the full journey and the feasibility of neighbourhood delivery
Affordability in open responses	75 of 180 substantive Q15 responses (41.7%)	Financial access remains a shared need despite differences in closed-question rankings
Information in open responses	61 of 180 (33.9%)	Clear information should support discovery, suitability decisions and action
Continuity in interviews	25 of 25 interviews	Build an achievable next step and a predictable rhythm into delivery
Welcome and trusted relationships	Welcome, dignity or belonging in 24 of 25 interviews; trusted people or networks in 23	Make inclusion visible in staff behaviour, relationships and familiar community settings

The best practice analysis reinforces these needs through recurring features in the mapped offers: low-cost entry, active family involvement, flexible multi-sport activity, partnerships and continuing opportunities. Eleven of the 18 records are classified as multi-sport. This indicates a common delivery format in the sample, rather than proof that multi-sport is more effective than a single-sport approach.

3.3. Support requirements within the samples:

Subgroup findings help identify needs that can disappear within an overall result. In Estonia, all 33 respondents reporting financial difficulty selected cost, while all 19 reporting a migrant or minority background selected own-language information, language-speaking staff and simple information. The 12 respondents reporting disability or support needs identified requirements that were less prominent in the complete sample. These results support targeted assistance alongside common access standards. In Greece, 12 of 22 respondents reporting financial difficulty (54.5%) selected cost and 11 (50.0%) selected transport, compared with 34.1% and 31.7% in the full sample. In Italy's financial-difficulty subgroup, eight of 12 (66.7%) selected cost and six (50.0%) selected the shortage of family opportunities. These

small groups illustrate how financial circumstances can interact with other conditions; they do not establish statistically reliable differences or the size of national disadvantaged populations. Latvia has no populated background fields from which to calculate comparable subgroup results. Italy and Spain have partial completion, with particularly small disclosed groups in Spain. Project partners should therefore avoid a pooled demographic profile or assumptions that a need is absent where disclosure is limited. Qualitative accounts and direct support conversations remain necessary to understand the circumstances of households that averages cannot describe.

3.4. Needs that intersect within a household:

Financial pressure can combine with shift work, unfamiliar language, disability-related support or long travel. A migrant parent may need both interpretation and an affordable, local session; a family of a neurodivergent child may need advance sensory information and a predictable coach; and a larger household may need a family price and activities suitable for several ages. Treating each barrier independently can require the family to coordinate several separate services before attendance is possible. The evidence also identifies family and community resources. Relatives provide encouragement, parents share information and transport, and families create informal activity and support networks. The project should build on this contribution while providing organisational support. Reliance on unpaid family effort alone may favour households with greater time, language confidence or existing connections.

3.5. Organisational needs:

Providers need the capacity to deliver what they promise. This includes predictable access to facilities, trained staff, equipment, outreach time, an identified family contact and funds for practical support. Italian and Greek accounts show that a nearby public facility can remain unavailable or unusable because of opening arrangements, maintenance or restricted access. The mapping shows that partnerships can connect expertise and resources, while also revealing the weakness of reporting on who attends and continues. The eight needs developed in section 4 consequently require action at several levels. Families can help specify workable arrangements; coaches can adapt delivery; organisations can simplify access and continuity; and public or community partners can support facilities, transport, funding and coordination. These organisational needs should be translated into practical requirements within the Framework and Guidebook.

4. Barriers, Challenges, and Priority Needs

Figure 1. The Move, Play & Belong family participation journey



Figure 1 illustrates the participation journey used to organise the Needs Assessment. Inclusive family sport depends not only on access to an activity, but on whether families can successfully move through the full journey: discovering an opportunity, deciding whether it is suitable, planning attendance, reaching the activity, participating meaningfully, experiencing a sense of belonging and having a realistic opportunity to continue. The eight priority needs identified in this assessment operate across and between these stages. A barrier at any one stage can prevent or interrupt participation even when the other conditions are in place.

The eight priority needs supporting the participation journey are:

1. Affordable participation and financial dignity
2. Clear information and supported navigation
3. Usable local venues and manageable journeys
4. Predictable provision with workable scheduling
5. Physical, sensory and communication accessibility
6. Respect, safety, cultural responsiveness and belonging
7. Meaningful whole-family participation and choice
8. Continuity and an achievable next step

4.1. Affordable participation and financial dignity

Families need to understand and manage the total cost of participation. Survey preferences and qualitative accounts identify charges for equipment, clothing, transport, food, siblings, membership, competition and restarting after an interruption. Estonia's cost barrier is particularly concentrated, but affordability is also the most common Q15 theme overall. Spain's small disclosed financial-difficulty subgroup cannot be read as evidence that financial exclusion is absent: 30.3% of the 33 respondents answering that item preferred not to disclose. The mapping confirms that family provision ranges from free municipal activity to membership-linked offers and fee-based residential camps. A free entry event may therefore lead towards an unaffordable next stage. The relevant need is affordable access over time, including the ability to try, pause and return with manageable financial risk.

The framework should require a total-cost assessment covering both introductory and continuation activity. Pilot organisers and future implementing organisations should consider free or subsidised trials, equipment lending, family or sibling pricing and confidential assistance, with a published explanation of what is included. Eligibility processes should avoid unnecessary disclosure and public identification of recipients. Recurring provision should be financially realistic before it is promoted as the next step. Latvia's ratings should not weaken this requirement. Its cost barrier and interviews still indicate financial pressure. A single European fee should not be inferred from the preference categories.

4.2. Clear information and supported navigation

Families need information that reaches them through credible channels and helps them act. Lack of information is the leading barrier in Greece and Spain; Estonia's migrant-family accounts show the importance of trusted people, visual explanation and patience. Latvia's families ask for operational details such as toilets, seating, food and registration, while Italy's communication preferences are distributed across municipal, digital and sport channels.

The best practice analysis identifies incomplete public information on costs and participation and recommends plain language, relevant languages, simple registration and local outreach. Together, the reports show that publicity alone is insufficient. Information should explain who can join, what happens, whether the whole family can attend and how support can be requested. The framework should specify a consistent minimum information set: dates and duration, location and directions, all charges, equipment, age and participation options, accessibility and sensory conditions, registration arrangements and a named contact. Pilot organisers and future implementing organisations should distribute this information through locally preferred channels, with a non-digital route and language or visual support where needed. Staff should check understanding through conversation rather than equating limited language confidence with limited ability.

A family contact should connect discovery, registration, practical questions and onward referral. Flexible registration, assistance with forms and on-site completion where suitable can reduce additional journeys or administrative effort. Information should be updated when arrangements change, and the contact should have access to current details rather than functioning only as a signpost.

4.3. Usable local venues and manageable journeys

Families need provision they can reach, use and return from without an excessive burden. The preference for activities closer to home appears across the study, while interviews identify fuel, parking, winter travel, public-transport schedules and the availability of an accompanying adult. In Greece's financial-difficulty subgroup, 11 of 22 respondents (50.0%) selected transport as a barrier. Proximity and physical availability are separate conditions. Italian families describe school gyms with restricted access, unstable arrangements and poor

maintenance. Greek accounts describe poorly maintained parks and limited pool access. Swimming and sailing in the mapping also illustrate dependence on facilities, equipment and environmental conditions.

The framework should require assessment of the household journey alongside the venue. Local organisers should check opening times, toilets, changing spaces, heating where relevant, accessible arrival, public transport after the session and realistic travel costs. Neighbourhood schools, community centres and parks should be considered where they are suitable and reliably available. Rural provision may require coaches to travel between settlements rather than expecting every family to travel to a central venue. Transport assistance should address a verified need and be considered alongside relocation or decentralisation of activity. Accessible parking, clear directions and coordinated journeys may be useful, but should not substitute for a feasible routine. Venue agreements should identify maintenance and access responsibilities so that families are not repeatedly redirected because facilities become unavailable.

4.4. Predictable provision with workable scheduling

Families need advance notice and a dependable rhythm, with options compatible with paid work, school, care, meals and rest. Latvia's unsuitable-timing barrier (56.1%) is particularly prominent. Italian shift-working households and Greek families with limited shared time show why a conventionally convenient slot may still exclude people. Flexibility should be designed within a predictable offer. The mapping contains weekly, recurring, seasonal, annual and project-based arrangements, while the interviews show that continuity can also mean a regular monthly session. Estonia has stronger survey interest in weekly provision; Latvia favours weekend and parent-child formats and records low selection of weekly sessions. These patterns support different participation rhythms.

Pilot organisers and future implementing organisations should consult families before fixing the schedule, publish dates sufficiently early and consider more than one feasible participation window. Make-up sessions, suitable drop-in arrangements or re-entry after an absence can reduce the risk attached to irregular work or care. Pilot evaluation should establish whether non-attendance reflects scheduling, other barriers or a family's preferred frequency. Regularity should not become a requirement that only households with stable working hours can meet. A missed session should not automatically lead to lost membership, repeated enrolment charges or a feeling of being permanently behind. Where facilities or staffing limit options, those limits should be explained and alternatives negotiated with families.

4.5. Physical, sensory and communication accessibility

Families need practical adaptation across the venue, activity, equipment, communication and staff response. In Greece, accessible venues were selected by 24 of 41 respondents (58.5%) and trained inclusive coaches by 23 (56.1%). Estonia's overall result that many respondents required no specific accessibility support should not obscure the needs described by its 12 respondents reporting disability or support requirements. Interviews identify noise, group size, changing rooms, quiet space, fear, assistance and the choice to observe or take a break. Latvia's

responses extend usability to pushchairs, baby-changing facilities and rest areas. Disability-focused practices such as Train4Family, Valttiplus and the Special Olympics family programmes show ways to combine activity with staff development, guidance and peer support. Their descriptions do not prove that equivalent support is available in every general offer. The framework should require a venue and activity accessibility check, a private opportunity to discuss support needs and a plan for suitable adaptations. Coaches should offer different rules, intensity, equipment and ways to understand an activity. Families should know sensory conditions and break arrangements before attending. Assistance should be agreed with the participant and family rather than assumed. Staff training should be supported by practical briefing, access to specialist advice where required and cover when a key staff member is absent. Shared community participation should remain available with appropriate support, alongside specialist options chosen by families. Providers should describe what they can accommodate accurately and agree on a supported alternative where the current setting cannot meet a need safely.

4.6. Respect, safety, cultural responsiveness and belonging

Families need respectful treatment and confidence that concerns will be heard. Welcome, dignity or belonging appeared in 24 interviews and trusted networks in 23. Accounts describe patient coaching, familiar faces and non-judgemental communication as reasons to return, and fear of judgement or unprepared staff as reasons to withdraw. The framework should define staff conduct, accessible safeguarding information, a clear route for concerns and support for beginners as minimum project standards. Coaches should use language and behaviour that respect participants' abilities, family structures and financial circumstances. Cultural responsiveness includes asking about clothing, changing, food or scheduling requirements and discussing reasonable delivery options with families, without assuming identical preferences within a group. Belonging should be supported through consistent staff, opportunities for families to meet and optional peer support. The mapping's family camps and support networks illustrate this social component. Families should be able to choose the extent of social contact; similarity of background should not become an admission condition or an automatic reason for separate provision.

4.7. Meaningful whole family participation and choice:

Families need an offer that accommodates the people who make attendance possible. Italy's leading barrier is the shortage of family-oriented opportunities, and interviews describe parents as payers and drivers rather than participants. Latvian larger-family accounts show that an activity suitable for only one child can require others to remain outside. Spanish accounts emphasise diverse households and the value of cooperative activity. The mapping supports active family involvement, flexible multi-sport delivery and age-appropriate options. However, the label family-friendly does not establish that every member has a meaningful role. The framework should distinguish genuine shared participation from children-only activity with adult supervision. Activity plans should allow parents and carers, children, siblings and other relatives to participate together or in parallel. Mixed-age stations, adaptable games, rest and quiet options can reduce the need to choose which family member receives an opportunity.

Where supervision for younger children is offered, staffing and responsibilities should be explicitly agreed. Families should also be free to choose observation or support roles without being treated as unsuccessful participants. Enjoyment, confidence and shared experience should be legitimate objectives alongside skill development. Cooperative challenges and recreational options can serve families who find visible scoring or competitive pressure uncomfortable. Participants who want sporting progression should have that choice.

Children's views should be included early enough to influence programme design and gathered through age- and communication-appropriate methods, such as short conversations, picture-based choices, drawings or simple visual feedback. Consultation should explore what children enjoy, what they find difficult and what they would change. The specific participant age range and facilitation responsibilities will be agreed during pilot planning.

4.8. Continuity and an achievable next step:

Families need to know what follows an initial experience and whether that next step remains suitable. Continuity, predictability or follow-up appeared in every interview. Survey responses also identify club information, named contacts, familiar coaches or groups, trials and equipment support as continuation priorities. These are preferences for support, not measured retention effects. The mapping shows both annual events and continuing municipal, club and family-support offer. One-day activity can introduce sport and create social contact, but it does not automatically establish a routine. Spain's interviews also identify the value of games that families can repeat independently. A supported pathway should therefore recognise recurring organised sport and suitable family activity outside clubs.

Every introductory activity should connect to an identified next opportunity with a date or reliable contact, clear costs, available places and confirmed adaptations. The organiser should give this information before departure, agree an appropriate follow-up channel and help with registration or referral where needed. Sending families a general list without checking practical suitability may leave the original barrier unresolved. Continuity depends on delivery capacity. Implementing organisations should confirm appropriate venue, staffing and support arrangements for any continuing opportunity and agree responsibility for receiving referrals. Evaluation should distinguish an intention to continue from actual participation and record why families pause or leave when they choose to explain. Re-entry should be supported without requiring the household to negotiate the whole system again.

5. Transferable Practices and Enabling Factors

Municipal entry points and recurring local activity - Liikuntahulinat in Helsinki and Perheliikunta in Tampere illustrate municipal provision with recurring family sessions, courses or events. Their relevance is the combination of a familiar local institution, family-oriented programming and a relatively accessible entry arrangement. Perheliikunta is recorded as free; Liikuntahulinat includes charges for adults and older participants, with children under nine free in the listed offer. These examples demonstrate different access arrangements rather than one standard price model. For this project, the transferable feature is recurring provision close to everyday family settings. The model could respond to information and proximity needs where municipalities, schools or community venues are trusted and usable.

Partnerships that coordinate family access - Cork and Waterford Sports Partnerships connect local authorities, clubs and families through ongoing programmes. Inclusive Family Activity Days in Limassol combines community organisations and municipal partners through recurring workshops and events. These descriptions offer useful examples of coordination across organisations that hold different resources and relationships. The project can adapt this coordination by identifying who handles outreach, registration, the venue, adaptation, family support and continuation. A named contact and a shared referral process can reduce fragmentation. Transfer requires an agreement on responsibilities and capacity; an informal expectation that another organisation will receive families is insufficient. Community project partners should be involved in planning and resourced for the contribution requested of them.

Guidance and adapted family support - Train4Family Palermo combines adapted sport and family wellbeing activity with organisational and coaching support. Valttiplus links family physical-activity counselling, staff training and local pilots. The Finnish, Portuguese and Swedish Special Olympics family initiatives include combinations of sport, information, peer support, family networks and introductions to local clubs. Their contribution is the recognition that some families need help identifying suitable activity and sustaining confidence, alongside adaptations during the session. This responds to the sensory-access accounts in Estonia and Greece and the navigation concerns found across the survey report. The project should consider an agreed support conversation and access to specialist expertise, while ensuring that support remains connected to ordinary local participation where families want it. Transfer conditions are substantial. Counselling requires staff time and suitable expertise; camps can require accommodation, travel and assistance; and a support network needs continuity beyond a particular project. The Finnish camp's recorded EUR 150 per person fee illustrates why strong family inclusion features can coexist with an affordability barrier. Subsidy and the total household cost require consideration before a similar format is selected.

Clubs as routes into sustained participation - Pfeffersport, Eintracht Frankfurt, Inklusive Alster, DOSB-linked swimming provision and MTV Stuttgart illustrate weekly or seasonal club and public-facility routes. These models show how family activity can sit within established provision, with different funding and membership arrangements. Inklusive Alster

also illustrates the specialised equipment and venue dependencies of sailing. Their principal opportunity for the project is continuity: an introductory activity can connect to a recurring group and familiar coach. That connection should be negotiated before recruitment. Fees, enrolment, transport, equipment, family roles and adaptations should be checked again for the receiving club. The survey warns that ordinary club activity can treat parents as logistical support and make progression more expensive. A club route should therefore demonstrate family usability rather than rely on membership as evidence of inclusion.

Events connected to the next opportunity - Stara Zagora's Inclusive Family Sport Days, Larnaca's Family Sport Festivals and Gdańsk's Active Family Days provide annual introductory formats. They are relevant to the preference for one-day family events in Greece and particularly Spain. A visible event can allow people to try activities with limited initial commitment. The project should use events where they fit local preferences, with recurring options and onward guidance incorporated from the outset. Practical follow-up can include meeting the receiving coach, arranging a trial, confirming a next date or giving families accessible ideas and equipment for activity together. Success should be assessed through the experience and subsequent opportunities taken up, alongside the number attending on the day.

Peer support and flexible activity design - Across the mapped offers, peer support, whole-family participation and multi-sport flexibility provide ways to respond to isolation, varied confidence and different abilities. The Swedish family programme's digital inspiration meetings illustrate one additional contact route, while camps and community sessions create opportunities for families to meet in person. Digital contact should complement an accessible local route rather than become a requirement. Flexible activity stations can enable a family to choose different levels of intensity, rules or roles. Peer supporters can accompany a first visit or explain how an activity works. These mechanisms should be optional and supported by staff. They should not transfer responsibility for interpretation, safeguarding or specialist assistance entirely to other parents.

Conditions for responsible transfer - Each selected practice should be assessed against the actual need it is expected to meet, its total cost, staff and facility requirements, cultural and language suitability, provision for different family members and its route to continuation. Project partners should then test the adapted approach with families and record changes. These transferable features should directly inform the practical content of the subsequent WP3 outputs. Relevant approaches can be translated into Guidebook case studies, implementation checklists, activity examples, communication templates and Toolkit resources so that municipalities, clubs, federations, NGOs and other community organisations can adapt effective features to their own circumstances without attempting to reproduce the original initiatives in full.

6. EU Policy Context and Institutional Challenges

The policy dimension of this Needs Assessment is considered at European Union level. No comparative country-by-country policy analysis was undertaken within the evidence available for this report. Accordingly, this section does not make claims that an individual partner country lacks a particular policy, funding mechanism or institutional provision. Instead, it identifies institutional challenges arising from the WP2 participation evidence and considers them in relation to relevant European policy priorities.

The European Union Work Plan for Sport 2024–2027 provides a particularly relevant policy reference for Move, Play & Belong. The Work Plan identifies participation in sport and health-enhancing physical activity as one of its principal priority areas and seeks to increase participation at all ages while improving accessibility for vulnerable groups. It also supports grassroots sport, evidence-informed policy and recognition of sport's contribution to health, social cohesion and active citizenship. These priorities provide a common European policy basis for examining whether practical sports provision enables socially at-risk families to participate.

For MPB, the relevance of this policy context lies primarily in implementation. The family evidence identifies barriers associated with affordability, information, transport, facility access, scheduling, accessibility, staff capacity and continuity. The central policy-related question is therefore not simply whether inclusive principles exist, but whether organisations have the resources, coordination arrangements and delivery mechanisms required to translate those principles into usable opportunities for families.

The Best Practice Analysis identifies several relevant international and European reference points, including the WHO Guidelines on Physical Activity and Sedentary Behaviour, the revised European Sports Charter, UNESCO's Kazan Action Plan and Erasmus+ inclusion and diversity priorities. This Needs Assessment additionally uses the European Union Work Plan for Sport 2024–2027 as a common EU-level sport-policy reference. Table 4 summarises the principles most relevant to MPB; it does not constitute an independent legal or national policy audit.

Table 4. EU and international policy context relevant to Move, Play & Belong

Policy Reference	Principle Summarised in the Source	Implication for the Project
WHO Guidelines on Physical Activity and Sedentary Behaviour 2020	Value of physical activity across population groups, including people living with disability	Provide appropriate participation options across ages and abilities
Revised European Sports Charter 2021	Access, participation and inclusion in sport policy	Consider whether practical delivery enables families to use an offer

Policy Reference	Principle Summarised in the Source	Implication for the Project
UNESCO Kazan Action Plan 2017	Inclusion, sustainable development and cross-sector cooperation	Connect sport with local public and community support
Erasmus+ inclusion and diversity priorities	Inclusion and diversity as horizontal programme priorities	Integrate access considerations into planning, delivery and evaluation
European Union Work Plan for Sport 2024–2027	Participation in sport and health-enhancing physical activity; increased participation at all ages; improved accessibility for vulnerable groups; support for grassroots sport and evidence-informed policy	Use the Framework to translate EU-level participation and inclusion objectives into practical family-sport delivery requirements, with particular attention to accessibility, local implementation and socially at-risk families

EU-level policy commitments establish an important strategic direction but do not by themselves show how inclusive family-sport provision functions in particular local settings. The issues below are therefore treated as institutional and implementation challenges emerging from the WP2 evidence, rather than as findings that any partner country lacks a particular policy, funding mechanism or legal provision.

- **Whole-household affordability and support** – Families experience participation costs across members and over time, including fees, equipment, travel and accompanying carers. The Framework should encourage funders and implementing organisations to consider the complete household cost when planning subsidies and programme budgets and to make available support clear and accessible. Reported financial difficulty should not be interpreted as evidence of a national funding-policy gap.
- **Recurring activity and continuity** – One-off and project-based activities can provide useful entry points, but the evidence shows that families also need realistic continuation opportunities. Implementation planning should therefore identify a continuation host, suitable venue, staffing, inclusion support and feasible resources before a sustained pathway is promised.
- **Reliable access to suitable facilities** – Interview accounts identify restricted access, unstable arrangements and maintenance problems in some local settings. The

Framework should promote clear agreements concerning opening times, accessible use, maintenance, equipment storage and responsibility when facilities become unavailable. Local implementation planning should confirm that proposed facilities can be used at workable times before activities are promoted.

- **Capacity to deliver practical inclusion** – Physical, sensory and communication barriers show that an inclusion commitment does not necessarily make an activity usable. Implementing organisations should define inclusion responsibilities, provide practical staff preparation and establish access to specialist advice where necessary. Delivery planning should confirm what adaptations and support can realistically be provided.
- **Coordination of information and referral** – Families may remain unaware of suitable opportunities even where activities exist. Future implementing organisations should establish who is responsible for accurate information, registration support and onward referral, and whether receiving organisations have capacity to accept participants. School, community and service involvement should be based on agreed roles and appropriate consent.
- **Monitoring equity and involving families in decisions** – The evidence supports proportionate monitoring of who is reached, what support is required, whether families can participate meaningfully and what barriers remain. Family feedback should inform delivery changes without requiring unnecessarily long forms or sensitive personal information. Where possible, implementing organisations should align the common MPB monitoring approach with existing local reporting requirements.

7. Country Priorities and Local Adaptation

The country priorities presented below are intended to inform Framework adaptation, translation, stakeholder engagement, training and future replication. They should not be interpreted as requiring a separate full-scale project pilot in every partner country. Under the approved work plan, the formal project pilot is conducted in Latvia through the BeActive Family Beach Games. The other countries' findings should inform national adaptation, dissemination and subsequent uptake of the Framework.

Table 5. Participation formats and continuation support by sample

Sample	Participation in Previous 12 Months	Leading Format Selected	Leading Continuation Support Selected
Estonia (N = 43)	25 (58.1%)	Weekly sessions 23 (53.5%)	Same coach or group 28 (65.1%)
Italy (N = 43)	27 (62.8%)	Parent-child activity 19 (44.2%)	Named contact 21 (48.8%)
Latvia (N = 41)	22 (53.7%)	Weekend programme and parent-child activity each 20 (48.8%)	Local club or weekly-session information 22 (53.7%)
Greece (N = 41)	19 (46.3%)	One-day family event 21 (51.2%)	Local club or weekly-session information 23 (56.1%)
Spain (N = 40)	23 (57.5%)	One-day family event 30 (75.0%)	Local club or weekly-session information 21 (52.5%)

- Estonia - The priority is affordable recurring provision combined with targeted language and accessibility support. A suitable local approach could combine a low-cost recurring session, familiar contact, equipment lending, targeted communication and agreed adaptations. Rural delivery may also consider suitable school or community settings and travelling instructors where feasible.

- Italy - Priorities are meaningful family participation, workable schedules and dependable local facilities. Local delivery could test shared or parallel parent-child and sibling activities, supported by a named contact and clear whole-household costs. Facility access and maintenance arrangements should be confirmed before recurring provision is promoted.

- Latvia - Priorities are suitable timing, proximity, varied family participation and a predictable but flexible rhythm. Weekend, school-holiday or regular monthly formats could be tested, with practical information communicated early and suitable options

available for different ages. Schools and kindergartens may provide useful communication routes alongside locally appropriate digital channels.

- Greece - Priorities concern information, transport, accessibility and supported navigation. A local approach could connect schools, municipalities and trusted community organisations with simple registration, clear accessibility information and recurring family activity. Introductory events should lead to suitable local opportunities, with sensory and assistance needs considered before delivery.

- Spain - Priorities are direct communication and a supported route from approachable one-day events into continuing local activity. Locally preferred communication channels should be combined with a named bridge contact and clear information about subsequent opportunities, costs, equipment and accessibility. Affordability and diverse household participation should remain part of the support package.

- Germany and the wider consortium - Germany contributes five mapped practices but has no family survey or interview sample. Its examples can inform recurring club provision, facility-dependent sport and potential continuation routes, but they do not provide direct evidence of German family needs. Any subsequent localisation or implementation in Germany should therefore combine the available contextual evidence with appropriate local consultation. The absence of direct family survey evidence should not be used to infer either the presence or absence of specific needs.

8. Strategic Recommendations and Implementation Responsibilities

8.1. Recommended requirements for the Move, Play & Belong Framework

The consolidated findings identify eight strategic recommendations for the development of the Move, Play & Belong Framework. Each recommendation translates an identified need into a practical response and is accompanied by an illustrative implementation example. Together, they provide a basis for designing inclusive family sport opportunities that families can access, understand, enjoy and sustain. The recommendations draw on the family evidence and mapped practices; the examples illustrate possible approaches rather than universally applicable or independently proven interventions.

Recommendation 1: Involve families in planning and shaping participation
Before finalising an activity, the formal pilot and any organisation subsequently adapting the Framework should consult families about its format, timing, location, journey, cost, participation roles and support arrangements. Consultation should include families with limited or no recent participation, alongside those already connected to partner organisations. Children's views should be gathered through methods appropriate to their age, communication preferences and support needs. Depending on the participant group, methods may include short individual or small-group conversations, picture-based choices, drawings, simple visual rating exercises or short interviews. Where appropriate, child-friendly questions may also be incorporated into the pre- and post-event assessment process. The method should allow children to express what they enjoy, what makes participation difficult and what they would change about the activity. Where communication or other support is required, consultation should be adapted accordingly and may involve a trusted adult where this supports, rather than replaces, the child's own contribution. Families should have opportunities to influence the design before decisions are fixed. The resulting delivery plan should explain how family feedback has shaped the activity and identify any needs that remain unresolved. Family and provider review should establish whether different household members can participate together or through suitable parallel activities, without a carer or sibling being unintentionally excluded.

The specific participant age range and allocation of partner responsibilities for facilitating this consultation will be agreed through consortium planning for the pilot. These operational details should therefore be established before participant recruitment rather than assumed within D2.3.

Example - Before confirming an activity, organisers could hold a short family consultation on preferred timing, participation format and support needs. Adults could comment through a brief discussion or form, while children could contribute through pictures, drawings, visual choices or short conversations. The organiser would then record which aspects of the activity were changed in response.

Recommendation 2: Address affordability across initial and continuing participation
Implementing organisations should provide a household cost assessment before delivery and budget for the support required. Possible measures include free or subsidised trials, equipment

lending, family or sibling pricing and assistance with necessary travel. Families should receive clear information about all charges and what is included. Assistance should be offered through confidential and proportionate procedures that avoid unnecessary disclosure or public identification of recipients. Affordability should be reassessed when families move into continuing activities. A low-cost introductory session should lead to a financially realistic next opportunity, with arrangements that allow families to pause and return. Pilot assessment should examine whether the financial support offered responds to the barriers experienced by participating families and whether that support can be accessed without stigma or unnecessary disclosure.

Example - An organiser could calculate the likely household cost of the activity, including participation fees, equipment and travel, and then combine a subsidised trial with equipment lending or family/sibling pricing where cost is identified as a barrier. Information provided to families should state clearly what is free, what has a charge and what financial support is available.

Recommendation 3: Combine clear information with personal guidance

Information should be distributed through locally preferred and trusted channels, including schools, municipalities, clubs and community organisations where appropriate. Non-digital routes should remain available, with additional language or visual support where required. An identified family contact should help households interpret the information, discuss support needs, complete registration and assess the suitability of further activities. This role requires access to current operational information and sufficient time to respond to enquiries. Pilot assessment should examine whether families can discover the activity, understand the offer and complete registration through a route they trust.

Example - A local activity could be promoted through a trusted school, municipality or community organisation using a short, plain-language message that states the date, location, costs, age and family participation options, accessibility arrangements and registration steps. A named contact could then help families complete registration or discuss individual support needs.

Recommendation 4: Integrate accessibility, staff preparation, safety and belonging into delivery

Pilot organisers and future implementing organisations should check the venue and activity, discuss support needs privately with families, agree adaptations and brief staff before sessions. Coaching should accommodate different abilities, communication needs and preferred levels of participation. Staff preparation should include safeguarding, respectful communication, cultural responsiveness and access to specialist advice where necessary. Suitable staff cover should preserve agreed support when a familiar coach is absent. Pilot assessment should examine whether participants can use the venue and activity with the physical, sensory and communication support they require, whether they experience respectful and inclusive participation and whether concerns can be raised through an accessible route.

Example - Before the activity, the provider could complete a venue and activity check covering physical access, changing facilities, noise, quiet or break spaces and communication needs. Staff could receive a short briefing on agreed adaptations, while families could privately explain any support required before arrival.

Recommendation 5: Provide meaningful family participation through suitable formats and scheduling

Pilot organisers and future implementing organisations should consult families before fixing schedules, provide advance notice and consider more than one feasible participation window where resources allow. Drop-in arrangements, make-up sessions and supported return after absence may help households affected by irregular work or care. Predictability should enable families to plan without making uninterrupted attendance a condition of inclusion. Activities should allow shared or parallel participation by different ages and abilities. Adaptable games, mixed-age activity stations, rest options and agreed arrangements for younger children can reduce the need to choose which family member receives an opportunity. Families should be free to select active, observational or supportive roles. Recreational, cooperative and sporting progression options should reflect their preferences. These arrangements should also support respectful and culturally responsive participation. Pilot assessment should identify which work, care or household circumstances remain excluded, whether different family members have meaningful roles and whether the format supports a welcoming experience.

Example - Where family feedback identifies difficulties with weekday attendance, an organisation could test a predictable weekend or monthly session. Mixed-age activity stations, shared parent-child activities and suitable parallel options could allow different members of the household to participate without requiring every family member to undertake the same activity.

Recommendation 6: Connect introductory activities to an achievable next opportunity

Before recruitment, implementing organisations should confirm an appropriate recurring activity or another supported route into continued family participation. Families should receive a date or reliable contact, complete cost information, confirmation of available places and details of relevant adaptations. Support may include meeting the receiving coach, arranging a trial, assisting with registration or providing suitable activities that families can repeat independently. Familiar staff and peer relationships should be maintained where possible, with supported re-entry after interruption. Pilot assessment should confirm whether participants receive a concrete next opportunity that appears suitable, accessible and financially realistic. Actual take-up of that opportunity should only be assessed through post-event follow-up where consent, an appropriate continuation opportunity and project resources make this feasible.

Example - Before participants leave an introductory event, organisers could provide a specific next opportunity, including its date, location, cost, available places and contact person. Where

appropriate, the family could be introduced to the receiving coach or assisted to register for a trial session.

Recommendation 7: Secure usable venues, manageable journeys and reliable organisational arrangements

Neighbourhood provision should be considered where suitable facilities are available. Transport assistance should respond to an identified need and be assessed alongside the possibility of bringing activity closer to families. Delivery agreements should identify responsibility for facility access, maintenance, equipment, staffing, outreach, adaptations and follow-up. Providers should distinguish resources already secured from those still required. Relevant public, community and funding organisations should be involved where a dependency extends beyond the organising provider's control. Pilot assessment and future implementation planning should establish whether the venue is reliably available, whether households can reach it and return home, and whether the organisational arrangements can sustain the promised activity. These checks should take place before provision is promoted.

Example - Before promoting an activity, the organiser could assess the journey from the family's perspective, including public transport after the session, parking, accessibility, toilets and changing facilities. Where travel is a major barrier, a suitable school, community centre or other neighbourhood venue could be considered before introducing additional transport support.

Recommendation 8: Use monitoring and family feedback to improve equity and delivery

Families should have accessible opportunities to explain what worked, what remained difficult and what should change. Feedback should inform documented adjustments to delivery and subsequent Framework development. Monitoring should remain proportionate and should not make assistance conditional on disclosure of sensitive personal circumstances. The national project partners should review whether the measures identify unmet needs, differences in access and the practicality of continuation. This recommendation applies across affordability, information, journeys, scheduling, accessibility, belonging and whole-family participation.

Example - Organisers could use a short post-activity feedback tool asking whether families understood the offer, felt welcome, received the support requested and would consider participating again. A small number of operational measures, such as first attendance, support requested and next-step information provided, could then be reviewed alongside family comments to identify adjustments.

The eight strategic recommendations in D2.3 address participation and inclusion needs identified through the WP2 evidence. The wider project proposal also includes educational content relating to physical activity, health, wellbeing and nutrition within subsequent project outputs. These components should be incorporated in accordance with the approved work plan, but should not be presented as additional needs identified by the family survey unless they are independently supported by the evidence.

8.1.1. Relationship between the Recommendations and Subsequent Project Outputs

The eight recommendations should be embedded across subsequent WP3 outputs. Family involvement, affordability, accessibility, scheduling, whole-family participation and continuation should inform Framework delivery standards; the Guidebook should translate these into practical planning and implementation guidance; the Toolkit should support information, navigation and family-facing resources; and the monitoring recommendations should inform the pilot evaluation and future implementation tools. This provides a direct evidence-to-design link between D2.3 and WP3.

8.2. Prioritisation and resource decisions:

Before pilot recruitment, the immediate priority should be to establish a feasible and dependable offer. This requires a usable venue, suitable staff and adaptations, clear costs and information, a workable schedule and an identified continuation route. These conditions are interdependent and should be assessed together. Resource decisions should respond to locally verified barriers. Nearby delivery may reduce the need for transport assistance, while specialised activity may justify additional transport or equipment expenditure. A small recurring programme may provide a manageable route into continued participation, while an introductory event may be appropriate where families prefer that format. Prioritisation should preserve the proposal's emphasis on scalability, adaptability and implementation in resource-limited settings. The Framework should therefore distinguish essential inclusion requirements from higher-resource options and provide alternative delivery approaches where equivalent objectives can be achieved with fewer resources. Higher-cost measures such as organised transport, specialist staffing or major facility adaptations should be considered where verified need and available resources justify them, rather than being treated as universal requirements for every local implementation.

8.3. Roles in Needs Assessment, Framework Development, Pilot Implementation and Future Adoption:

Responsibilities should be distinguished between the work of the MPB consortium during the funded project and the responsibilities of organisations that subsequently adopt or implement the Framework locally.

ICSSPE and WP2 responsibilities – As lead partner for the Research and Needs Assessment work package, ICSSPE consolidated the WP2 evidence, coordinated preparation of D2.3 and the final consortium validation, and incorporated agreed revisions into the final report. Consortium partners contributed country-specific evidence, contextual interpretation and feedback. The validated Needs Assessment now provides the evidence base for subsequent Framework development.

Responsibilities during subsequent Framework development - Responsibility for the development of the Framework, Guidebook, Toolkit, educational content, translations and validation should follow the approved project work plan. The relevant task leads and contributing project partners should use the findings of D2.3 to ensure that subsequent project outputs reflect the identified needs while remaining adaptable across national and community contexts. Country project partners should support localisation, stakeholder consultation and validation of materials rather than being assumed to operate identical programmes in every country.

Responsibilities during the formal project pilot - The formal project pilot is the implementation of the Framework at the BeActive Family Beach Games in Latvia. Pilot planning, delivery, participant engagement, pre- and post-event assessment and feedback collection should follow the responsibilities assigned under WP4. LSFC and UFEC co-lead the planning and implementation of the BeActive Family Beach Games, while ICSSPE leads the pre- and post-event assessment and scientific evaluation. Other consortium partners contribute according to the approved work plan through participant engagement, observation, stakeholder involvement, feedback and refinement of the Framework.

Responsibilities of future local adopters - Where a municipality, sports organisation, club, NGO, federation, school, community organisation or other provider adopts or hosts implementation of the Framework, that organisation should assume responsibility for the practical arrangements within its control. These may include venue access, staffing, scheduling, outreach, participant communication, adaptations, equipment, safeguarding, local costs, continuation pathways and proportionate monitoring. Where more than one organisation contributes to delivery, responsibilities should be agreed locally and recorded clearly.

Role of families and community representatives - Families and community representatives should not be treated as responsible for overcoming organisational barriers. Their role is to contribute experience, assess the usability of proposed activities, identify missing needs, suggest adaptations and choose suitable participation and feedback routes. Consultation should be accessible, proportionate and respectful of privacy.

Consortium responsibilities should remain consistent with the approved project work plan - D2.3 may recommend implementation functions for future adopters, but it should not create additional binding responsibilities for consortium partners or external organisations beyond those already agreed. The longer-term role of the consortium is primarily to support transfer, dissemination, advocacy, knowledge exchange and uptake, while routine local delivery and monitoring should progressively sit with organisations adopting the Framework.

8.4. Implementation sequence

The implementation sequence should follow the structure of the approved project work plan and distinguish between Framework development, formal pilot testing, and future local adoption.

- **Translate the findings into the Framework -** The eight identified needs and strategic recommendations should be converted into practical design requirements for WP3. The Framework should define common principles and delivery standards, while the Guidebook and Toolkit should provide practical guidance, resources, examples and adaptable tools for implementation.
- **Adapt, translate, and validate project materials -** Consortium project partners should support localisation of the Framework, Guidebook, Toolkit and educational materials in accordance with the approved WP3 responsibilities. Trainers, sports organisations, policymakers and other relevant stakeholders should be involved in checking the clarity, usability and contextual relevance of the materials.
- **Prepare and implement the formal Latvia pilot -** The Framework should be tested through the BeActive Family Beach Games in Latvia. Pilot organisers should confirm event logistics, recruitment arrangements, accessibility, staffing, participant communication, safeguarding, engagement strategies and the assessment process in accordance with WP4.
- **Conduct pre- and post-event assessment and stakeholder feedback -** Participant engagement and Framework performance should be assessed through the approved WP4 evaluation process. Feedback from families, organisers, trainers and other stakeholders should be used to identify strengths, implementation difficulties and areas requiring refinement.
- **Refine and finalise the Framework and supporting resources -** Pilot evidence and stakeholder feedback should be used to revise the Framework, Guidebook and Toolkit. Changes should be documented so that the relationship between evidence, feedback and final design decisions remains transparent.
- **Disseminate, train and support future adoption -** The finalised Framework and supporting materials should be disseminated through national and European networks. Workshops and stakeholder engagement should support municipalities, sports organisations, federations, clubs, NGOs and other community actors in understanding and applying the methodology.
- **Support long-term adoption and institutional integration -** The consortium should facilitate commitments from municipalities and sports organisations, promote the Framework through relevant networks and support policy and institutional uptake. Future local adopters should then assume responsibility for adapting, organising, delivering and monitoring activities within their own settings, using the Framework, Guidebook and Toolkit as practical resources.

9. Monitoring, Evaluation, and Learning

9.1. What the pilot should establish

The formal WP4 evaluation will use the approved pre- and post-event survey approach during the BeActive Family Beach Games. As the Latvia pilot is a one-day event, the evaluation should distinguish clearly between outcomes that can be assessed during the event and outcomes that would require later follow-up.

The pre-event assessment can establish relevant starting conditions within the agreed evaluation design, while the post-event assessment can examine participants' immediate experience of the pilot and any change in the measures defined for WP4. The assessment should also examine the practical performance of the Framework, including whether families understood the offer, were able to participate meaningfully, encountered unresolved barriers and received appropriate information about possible next opportunities. Measures collected during or immediately after the event can include participant reach, family involvement, accessibility and support needs, participation experience, perceived usability of the activity, motivation or confidence relating to future participation, and whether a concrete continuation opportunity was communicated.

Longer-term outcomes such as repeat attendance, take-up of a referral or sustained participation cannot be demonstrated by the one-day pilot itself. These should therefore be treated separately as supplementary post-event learning measures and should only be collected where participant consent, a suitable continuation opportunity, an agreed follow-up period and project resources make this feasible. Sustained participation and belonging are outcomes to investigate over time, rather than effects already demonstrated by the evidence. Attendance should be assessed alongside the experience of participating and the barriers that remain. A large event attendance count cannot establish continuing engagement; high satisfaction among attending families cannot establish that excluded households were reached. Monitoring should include families who enquire but do not attend where they agree to provide feedback, as well as people who attend once, continue or pause.

9.2. Proposal-defined Project Indicators

Monitoring should first retain the indicators and targets already established in the approved project proposal. These represent the formal project-level measures and should not be replaced by additional indicators introduced through the Needs Assessment. The principal proposal-defined measures relevant to participation, access and sustainability include:

- Engagement of at least 100 families, approximately 400 individuals, in direct in-person activities, alongside wider digital outreach;
- At least 80% of participating families reporting improved access to physical activity opportunities;
- At least 50% of participating families including members from at least two generations;
- Delivery of at least five online educational workshops and engagement of at least 1,000 individuals with educational resources;

- Participation of socially at-risk families at the level specified for the BeActive Family Beach Games pilot;
- And commitment from at least 10 municipalities or sports organisations to future adoption or implementation of the Framework.

These indicators should remain the principal reference points for reporting against the approved project objectives.

9.3. Recommended Supplementary Learning Indicators

In addition to the proposal-defined indicators, D2.3 recommends a limited set of supplementary learning measures that can help explain how and why families are able to access, use and continue from the pilot experience. These measures should support Framework refinement rather than create additional contractual performance targets. Project partners should agree to common definitions before data collection and use short, proportionate records. Individuals, households and attendance episodes should be distinguished where relevant. Data collection should avoid unnecessary personal or sensitive information.

Table 6. Recommended supplementary monitoring and learning indicators

Indicator	Definition and Interpretation	Collection Point
Reach through trusted channels	Enquiries and registrations by referral or communication channel, where recorded; shows which routes generate contact, not total community coverage	At enquiry or registration
First attendance	Unique households and unique people attending at least once; record first attendance separately from subsequent episodes	Event registration / attendance record
Family involvement	Roles and age ranges of attending family members, with shared, parallel, support or observation options recorded proportionately	Registration and short session record
Access barriers and support	Practical needs requested, support agreed and support delivered; record unresolved needs without requiring a diagnostic label	Before and during delivery
Financial usability	Families' assessment of manageability and any unexpected costs; distinguish the advertised charge from equipment and travel	Post-event assessment; follow-up where feasible
Participation experience	Short optional feedback on respect, safety, activity suitability, understanding and confidence to return, with an open comment	Post-event assessment; periodic use during future implementation where relevant

Indicator	Definition and Interpretation	Collection Point
Intention and confidence to continue	Participant indication of whether they would like to continue participating, whether they understand what opportunity may be available next and whether they feel able to take that next step. This measures an immediate post-event outcome and should not be interpreted as evidence of actual continued participation.	Post-event assessment.
Continuation support	Households given a concrete next opportunity, and referrals or trials taken up where confirmed	At departure and follow-up
Post-event continuation	Confirmed participation in a subsequent organised or family activity at an agreed follow-up point, where consent, available opportunities and resources permit follow-up.	Post-event follow-up only
Interruptions and unresolved barriers	Voluntary reasons for pausing, leaving or not taking up a referral; distinguish unknown outcomes and organisational cancellations	During delivery and follow-up

9.4. Timing denominators and targets

The pre- and post-event surveys constitute the principal assessment points for the one-day pilot. Any later follow-up should be treated separately from the core event evaluation. Where a continuation opportunity exists and consent and resources permit, an agreed post-event contact point may be used to explore whether participants took up a subsequent opportunity. The timing of such follow-up should be determined through pilot planning and should reflect the type and frequency of continuation opportunities available. The proposal-defined targets should remain the formal project performance targets. Any additional targets attached to supplementary learning indicators should be agreed only after the relevant delivery context, observation period and data-collection capacity have been established.

9.5. Equity and family voice

Optional background information can help assess whether different families are reached, but should be collected only where it serves a clear purpose and can be handled appropriately. The survey's missing fields and small subgroups show the limits of detailed comparisons. Small groups should be described carefully, with denominators and without identifying combinations of personal characteristics. A low count should prompt further investigation or understanding of access rather than an automatic assumption that demand is absent. Feedback should be available through conversation, a short form, accessible visual responses or a family's preferred communication channel. Interpreting support and appropriate ways to include children's views should be considered. Providers should explain what changed in response to feedback, including where a requested change cannot be made and what alternative is available.

Monitoring data should be necessary, proportionate and accessible to authorised staff. The pilot must also be able to demonstrate the proposal commitment concerning the participation of socially at-risk families. Recruitment and eligibility procedures should therefore allow the project to evidence the required level of participation while remaining proportionate, respectful and compliant with ethical and data-protection requirements. Only information necessary to establish eligibility, analyse inclusion and support participation should be collected.

9.6. Interpreting results

Use attendance data with short qualitative accounts to examine how the access package worked. Compare intended arrangements with actual delivery and report changes, cancellations and missing follow-up. Differences between participant groups, delivery arrangements or future implementation settings can inform adaptation, but should be considered alongside recruitment, resources, provision frequency and family circumstances. Without an appropriate comparison design, improvements cannot be attributed solely to the intervention. The learning question is which arrangements appear to make participation more usable for which families, under what conditions. Findings should lead to revisions of the Framework and practical guidance. Promising mechanisms should remain open to adjustment where families identify an unresolved barrier.

10. Expert Review and Stakeholder Validation

The Needs Assessment underwent final expert and stakeholder validation through consortium review of the draft report. For the purposes of D2.3, this final partner review constituted the agreed validation process; no additional expert or stakeholder validation sessions are planned for this deliverable. Project partners reviewed the evidence interpretation, priority needs, strategic recommendations, implementation arrangements and overall usability of the report and provided written comments and proposed revisions. The feedback resulted in a more concise Executive Summary, reduced repetition, clearer practical examples for the strategic recommendations, additional guidance on incorporating children's views, a clearer distinction between measures that can be assessed during the one-day Latvia pilot and longer-term follow-up, and clarification that the policy dimension is addressed through a common EU-level policy context rather than a comparative national policy analysis. ICSSPE consolidated the substantive comments and incorporated the agreed revisions into this final version. D2.3 is therefore considered validated and final. Subsequent WP3 validation of the Framework, Guidebook, Toolkit and translated materials, and WP4 evaluation of the Latvia pilot, are separate stages that may further refine the Move, Play & Belong Framework but do not constitute outstanding validation of the Needs Assessment.

11. Conclusion

The Needs Assessment identifies a clear requirement for the Move, Play & Belong Framework: inclusive family sport must be usable across the complete participation journey. Families need to be able to find and understand an opportunity, judge whether it is affordable and suitable, organise attendance, reach and use the venue, participate with appropriate support and identify a realistic next step. The eight priority needs therefore provide a common basis for Framework development, while country differences indicate where local emphasis and adaptation are required.

The findings are descriptive rather than nationally representative. Cost is particularly prominent in the Estonian sample, family-oriented opportunities and facility arrangements in Italy, scheduling and household logistics in Latvia, and information and supported access in Greece and Spain. Known recording differences and flagged survey items also limit precise cross-country comparisons. The mapped initiatives provide transferable mechanisms—including recurring municipal activity, community partnerships, adapted family support, peer networks and club pathways—but do not establish programme effectiveness. Their value lies in design features that can be adapted according to need, resources and local circumstances.

At policy level, the assessment uses a common EU-level context rather than a comparative national policy audit. The European Union Work Plan for Sport 2024–2027 provides a relevant strategic reference through its emphasis on participation, accessibility for vulnerable groups, grassroots sport and evidence-informed policy. The institutional challenges identified through WP2 show where the Framework can help translate these principles into practical family-sport provision.

Following completion and consortium validation of D2.3, the identified priorities should now be translated into the WP3 Framework, Guidebook and Toolkit. The Framework should subsequently be tested through the formal Latvia pilot using the agreed pre- and post-event assessment approach and refined using participant, organiser and stakeholder evidence. Longer-term sustainability will depend on municipalities, sports organisations, clubs, federations, NGOs and other community actors adopting and adapting the Framework within their own contexts, supported by dissemination, capacity-building, knowledge transfer and advocacy through the project network.